

PRIME LOCAL GROWTH

The Local Social Blueprint

How to use Facebook, Instagram, and Nextdoor to drive local visibility and leads — even with no following, no budget, and no time to spare.

Level: Beginner **Time to implement:** 2–3 hours setup + 30 min/week

Results timeline: 2–6 weeks

The local social advantage: Most of your competitors are either posting random content with no strategy or not posting at all. That means showing up consistently — even with simple content — gives you a significant edge. You don't need to be a content creator. You need to be the most visible, credible business in your city.

1

Profile Optimization — Facebook & Instagram

Before posting a single piece of content, make sure your profiles are fully optimized. An incomplete profile loses customers the moment they click through.

Facebook Business Page checklist

- ☐ **Page name matches your GBP and website exactly**
Consistency across platforms is a trust signal.

- ☐ **Category set to your primary service**
Same logic as GBP — the most specific option available.

- ☐ **About section fully complete**
Business description using your primary keyword + city. Website URL. Phone. Email. Hours.

- ☐ **Cover photo is professional**
Team photo, truck/equipment, or job site. Size: 820×312px. No stock images.

- ☐ **Profile photo is your logo**
Consistent with all other platforms. Size: 180×180px.

- ☐ **Call-to-action button set**
Use "Call Now" or "Send Message" for service businesses.

- ☐ **Services section filled in**
List every service with a description — mirrors your GBP services.

- ☐ **Messenger auto-reply set up**
Settings → Messaging → set an instant reply so leads don't wait.

Instagram Business Profile checklist

- ☐ **Username is your business name**
Keep it clean — no underscores or numbers if possible.

- ☐ **Bio includes keyword + city + what you do**
Example: "San Antonio HVAC | Fast AC repair & installations | Call or DM for a free quote"

- ☐ **Website link in bio**
Link to your GBP or website homepage.

- ☐ **Contact buttons enabled**
Call, Email, and Directions buttons should all be active.

- ☐ **Highlights created**
Create 3–5 Story highlights: "Reviews," "Our Work," "Services," "About Us," "FAQ."

2

The 30-Day Content Calendar

Post 3 times per week on Facebook. Repurpose the same content to Instagram. This schedule rotates through 6 post types so your content never feels repetitive.

#	Post type	Goal	Frequency
1	Before & After	Demonstrate expertise, build credibility	Weekly
2	Tip / Educational	Establish authority, encourage saves/shares	Weekly
3	Social Proof / Review highlight	Trust, word-of-mouth	Bi-weekly
4	Behind the Scenes / Team	Humanize the business, build connection	Bi-weekly
5	Seasonal / Timely offer	Drive immediate calls/messages	Monthly
6	Community / Local	Local relevance, neighborhood trust	Monthly

Caption templates — copy, customize, post

Replace all **[BRACKETS]** with your own details.

POST TYPE 1 — BEFORE & AFTER

"Before → After 🛠️

[One sentence describing the problem the customer had.]

Our team came out to [CITY] and [one sentence describing what you did]. The result? [One sentence on the outcome.]

If you're dealing with [problem], don't wait until it gets worse. Give us a call or DM us for a free estimate.

📍 Serving [CITY] and surrounding areas

☎ [PHONE]

#[city]services #[cityname][servicetype] #localservice"

POST TYPE 2 — EDUCATIONAL TIP

"[CITY] homeowners — here's one thing most people don't know about [your service area]:

[Share 2–3 sentence tip. Keep it simple. Lead with the most useful information.]

This is the kind of thing we check for on every job. Questions? Drop them in the comments or send us a DM.

— [BUSINESS NAME]

☎ [PHONE]"

POST TYPE 3 — REVIEW HIGHLIGHT

"★★★★★ Another 5-star review!

'[Paste the actual review text here — even 1–2 sentences]'

— [Customer first name], [City]

Reviews like this are why we do what we do. Thank you, [Name]!

If you've worked with us and haven't left a review yet, we'd really appreciate it — link in bio.

🙌"

POST TYPE 4 — BEHIND THE SCENES

"A day in the life at [BUSINESS NAME] 🧑‍💻

[1–2 sentences about what your team was doing today / this week. Keep it real and human.]

We take pride in every job we do in [CITY]. No shortcuts, no BS — just quality work and honest service.

#[cityname] #[servicetype] #smallbusiness #locallyowned"

POST TYPE 5 — SEASONAL OFFER

"[SEASON] special for [CITY] residents 🍹

[BUSINESS NAME] is offering [specific offer] through [DATE].

[1 sentence on why this matters right now — e.g. "Summer heat is no joke — don't wait until your AC goes out."]

Limited spots available. Call [PHONE] or DM us to book.

#[city][service] #[cityname]"

3

Nextdoor Strategy for Local Service Businesses

Nextdoor is the most underused platform for local service businesses. It's a neighborhood-based network where people actively ask for service recommendations — and the businesses that show up consistently win the referrals.

Setup steps



Claim your free Business Page

Go to nextdoor.com/business. Set up your profile with full contact info, services, and a description that includes your city + service keywords.



Enable "Neighborhood Sponsorship"

For \$40–\$60/month you appear in the sidebar of every post in your target neighborhoods. Highest ROI local ad spend available.

**Ask satisfied customers to recommend you on Nextdoor**

Nextdoor recommendations are the platform's equivalent of Google reviews — and they show up in recommendation searches.

Organic Nextdoor strategy

Nextdoor allows business owners to post helpful content in their service area. Post once per week using this approach:

NEXTDOOR POST TEMPLATE — SEASONAL TIP

"Hi [NEIGHBORHOOD NAME] neighbors!

[BUSINESS NAME] here — we're a local [service] company serving [city] and surrounding neighborhoods.

Heading into [season], here's one thing you can do right now to [prevent a common problem]:

[2–3 sentences of genuinely useful advice.]

Happy to answer any questions — just reply here or reach us at [PHONE]. We offer free estimates and same-day availability for most jobs.

— [YOUR NAME], [BUSINESS NAME]"

Nextdoor golden rule: Be genuinely helpful first, promotional second. Posts that lead with useful advice get 3–5x more engagement than straight promotional posts. The recommendation algorithm rewards trusted, active businesses.

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Repurpose Google Posts as Social Content

If you're following the Google Business Blueprint, you're already writing 4 Google Posts per month. Don't write separate content — repurpose it across platforms in 5 minutes.

Google Post type	Facebook	Instagram	Nextdoor
Tip / Update	Post as-is, add hashtags	Resize image, same caption	Reframe as neighbor advice
Offer	Boost for \$5–10 in local radius	Use as Story with link sticker	Post with neighborhood callout
Job completed	Add before/after photos	Carousel post (before/after)	Post if in that neighborhood
Review highlight	Screenshot + post	Use Canva to make a graphic	Share as a recommendation story

Time-saver: Batch your content creation once per week. Write all 3 Facebook posts and your Google Post in one 30-minute sitting. Schedule them using Facebook's free built-in scheduler.

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Local Hashtag Research

The right hashtags put your posts in front of people searching locally — even if they don't follow you. Use 5–8 hashtags per post. Mix local + service tags.

Hashtag formula (replace with your details)

Type	Examples	Count
City + service	#SanAntonioHVAC #AustinPlumber #DallasRoofing	2
City general	#SanAntonio #SATXlocal #AustinTexas	2

Service general	#HVACrepair #localplumber #roofingcontractor	2
Trust/brand	#smallbusiness #locallyowned #familyowned	1–2

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Weekly 30-Minute Social Routine

- ☐ **Monday (10 min)**
 - Write and schedule 3 Facebook posts for the week using the content calendar. Repurpose to Instagram.
- ☐ **Wednesday (5 min)**
 - Post to Nextdoor. Respond to any comments or DMs from Monday's post.
- ☐ **Friday (10 min)**
 - Respond to all comments and messages from the week. Share or engage with 2–3 local community posts (builds goodwill and visibility).
- ☐ **Any day (5 min)**
 - Post a quick before/after or job site photo to your Story. Stories don't require captions and keep your profile active between posts.

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